STATE SCAN

GUJARAT: WHERE MEMORY CRASHED *PG 16* **MAHARASHTRA: A HARVEST OF TEARS** *PG 17*



NEW BEGINNINGS D.K. Shivakumar takes oath as new Karnataka chief minister, Jun. 3

ANS

KARNATAKA

TEAM DKS: FORM AND FORMULA

Caste rebalancing was tough, but fiscal balancing may be tougher as the new CM enters office with a fresh manifesto

By **Ajay Sukumaran**

KARNATAKA'S POWER TRANSITION WAS LIKE MAKING THE beads in a kaleidoscope move between two arrangements. The first pattern had to be gently disturbed—done on May 28, with the resignation of Siddaramaiah. Then a brief phase of flux had to be endured before coaxing it into a new pattern, equally symmetrical to the observing eye. That came about on June 3 as D.K. Shivakumar, 64, was sworn in as the new Congress chief minister. Party senior Dr G. Parameshwara came in as deputy CM—the relative weight of beads was crucial. A team of 12 ministers rounded off the ensemble.

Shivakumar, aka DKS, got a more muted coronation than he desired; a 'victory rally' was cancelled, giant posters were taken down, the oath-taking happened at the governor's house, not the Vidhana Soudha's grand steps. The high command reportedly felt a gala event would look indecorous in times of austerity. DKS scaled things back, reined in his supporters, and instead chose